The free plastic swap list

Six swaps my family made between August 2024 and September 2025, room by room, with what each one replaced and what we paid.

Kitchen

Cutting board

Plastic to bamboo

Every cut scrapes the board. On a plastic board, those scrapes are tiny pieces of plastic, and some of them end up in the food.

- **What we bought** Allsum bamboo cutting board
- **What we paid** $14.97
- **When** August 2024

Kitchen

Spatula

Plastic to stainless steel

Plastic and nylon spatulas wear down against hot pans. Stainless steel holds up to the heat.

- **What we bought** Zulay stainless steel spatula
- **What we paid** $12.99
- **When** November 2024

Kitchen

Food storage

Plastic to glass

Heat and scrubbing wear down plastic food containers over time. Glass holds leftovers just as well. The lids on ours are still plastic, so leave the lid off when you heat food.

- **What we bought** Rubbermaid Brilliance glass containers, set of 9
- **What we paid** $79.99
- **When** October 2024

Dishes

Dishwasher detergent

Pods to plastic-free tablets

Many dishwasher pods are wrapped in a film of polyvinyl alcohol, a plastic made to dissolve in water. Plain tablets have no film at all.

- **What we bought** Wild Clean unscented tablets, then Blueland plastic-free tablets
- **What we paid** $19.99 a month; $23.99
- **When** April 2025; September 2025

Bathroom

Toothbrush

Plastic to bamboo and boar bristle

A standard toothbrush has a plastic handle and nylon bristles. Ours have bamboo handles and natural boar bristles.

- **What we bought** Primals boar bristle and bamboo toothbrushes
- **What we paid** $27.99 a pack
- **When** July 2025

Closet

Underwear

Synthetic to cotton

Polyester and nylon are plastics, and clothes made from them shed tiny fibers. Cotton is a natural fiber.

- **What we bought** Amazon Essentials cotton boxer briefs, pack of 5
- **What we paid** $18.00
- **When** December 2024